

TOPIC 4: ENVIRONMENTAL POLLUTION

1. Meaning and Types

Pollution is the introduction of harmful substances or energy into the environment. Main types: **air**, **water**, **soil** and **noise** pollution.

2. Causes and Effects

Causes include industrial emissions, vehicle exhaust, dumping of waste, agricultural chemicals, oil spills and loud machinery. Effects: respiratory diseases, contaminated drinking water, loss of soil fertility, harm to wildlife, hearing damage and climate impacts.

3. Control and Prevention

- Use cleaner energy and efficient engines
- Proper waste disposal and treatment of industrial effluent
- Reduce use of harmful pesticides; practise organic methods where possible
- Laws and enforcement; public awareness
- Individual actions: do not litter, conserve resources, plant trees

4. Roles of Individuals and Government

Individuals can reduce, reuse and recycle and report pollution. Government agencies set standards, monitor the environment and punish offenders.

5. Summary

Pollution harms air, water, soil and living things. Prevention and control require personal responsibility and effective government action.

End of Topic 4